

Cover Letter – Principal Engineer at Engine

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Date: [Current Date]

Engine

[Company Address]

[City, State ZIP]

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Principal Engineer position at Engine. Your mission to revolutionize work travel by building a modern, seamless platform resonates deeply with me. I am inspired by the opportunity to help lead Engine's transition from monolithic applications to a distributed, scalable architecture that delivers exceptional experiences for businesses and their teams.

Why I'm Excited About Engine

Engine's focus on transforming business travel through technology and user-centric design aligns perfectly with my passion for building platforms that solve complex, high-impact problems. I am eager to contribute my expertise in distributed systems, cloud architecture, and technical leadership to help shape Engine's technical direction and drive innovation at scale.

Relevant Experience & Impact

Distributed Systems & Cloud Architecture - Over 20 years of experience designing, building, and evolving high-scale distributed systems for enterprise and SMB clients (Barclays, McKinsey, Biophy, Yotascale, Boomi, etc.) - Led major technical initiatives to break down monolithic applications into modular, loosely coupled microservices, ensuring scalability, resilience, and maintainability - Deep hands-on experience with AWS and cloud-native infrastructure, including best practices for reliability, performance, and cost optimization - Designed APIs, defined service boundaries, and implemented event-driven architectures, data consistency models, and robust service communication strategies (REST, gRPC, messaging)

Technical Leadership & Collaboration - Drove architectural vision and execution across multiple teams, influencing engineering direction at the organizational level - Mentored and coached engineers, fostering a culture of service ownership, strong engineering fundamentals, and thoughtful system design - Collaborated closely with engineering leaders, product managers, and cross-functional teams to align technical solutions with business needs - Guided teams

through complex technical challenges, making pragmatic decisions in ambiguous environments

Problem Solving & Pragmatism - Known for a pragmatic approach to balancing best practices with practical constraints, ensuring solutions are both effective and maintainable - Strong problem-solving skills, with a track record of delivering high-quality implementations in fast-paced, high-growth environments

Why I'm a Strong Fit for Engine

My experience leading the design and evolution of distributed systems, combined with my technical depth in cloud architecture and my passion for mentoring and collaboration, positions me to make a significant impact at Engine. I thrive on driving technical transformation and am eager to help Engine scale its platform to meet the needs of modern businesses and travelers.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my background and vision align with Engine's mission and how I can contribute to your continued success.

Sincerely,

Yongjun Rong